

REWILD

AN ECOLOGICAL EFFORT

CORE PRINCIPLES

- ✦ Protect Biodiversity
- ✦ Preserve Indigenous Knowledge
- ✦ Evidence-Based Action
- ✦ Promote Ecological Literacy
- ✦ Encourage Sustainable Living
- ✦ Connect Ecology with Arts

FOUNDING COLLABORATORS

Sanjay Kumar

Technology & Digital Infrastructure

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Humanities, Literature & Discourse

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01 / VISION, MISSION & PRINCIPLES

Vision, Mission & Core Principles

VISION

A world where every individual — regardless of geography, background, or profession — understands, values, and actively participates in protecting the natural world through ecological literacy, cultural engagement, and community action.

MISSION

REWILD is an open, interdisciplinary educational movement that bridges science, humanities, indigenous knowledge, and technology to cultivate ecological consciousness. Through a digital platform, call-for-papers, seminars, and podcasts, REWILD creates accessible and rigorous spaces for ecological learning and advocacy.

Core Principles

#	Principle	What It Means in Practice
1	Protect Biodiversity	Document, celebrate, and campaign for species and ecosystem preservation — from urban greening to wilderness conservation.
2	Promote Ecological Literacy	Make environmental science accessible and engaging for non-specialists through clear, jargon-free communication.
3	Preserve Indigenous & Traditional Ecological Knowledge	Recognize and honor the wisdom of communities whose relationship with the land predates modern conservation.
4	Encourage Sustainable Living	Translate systemic ecological issues into actionable everyday practices without moralising.
5	Evidence-Based Environmental Action	Ground all advocacy in peer-reviewed science, field data, and scholarly research.
6	Connect Ecology with Art, Literature & Culture	Use poetry, fiction, film, visual art, and oral tradition as vectors for ecological feeling and knowledge.

02 / MOVEMENT ARCHITECTURE OVERVIEW

Movement Architecture Overview

REWILD operates across four interlocking pillars. Each pillar is both independent (it functions and produces value on its own) and interdependent (it feeds content, community, and credibility into the others). The digital infrastructure, designed and maintained by Sanjay Kumar, provides the connective tissue. The intellectual and creative programming, led by Prasanna Kumar, provides the substance.

PILLAR	PRIMARY FORMAT	AUDIENCE	KEY OUTPUT
Website & Digital Hub	Web platform (articles, maps, data)	General public, students, researchers	Knowledge repository, biodiversity map, resource library
Call for Papers & Journals	Academic/creative submissions	Researchers, writers, activists	Peer-reviewed journal, essay collections
Seminars & Public Events	Webinars, workshops, lectures	Students, educators, policymakers	Recorded lecture series, workshop curricula
Podcasts & Digital Storytelling	Audio/video narratives	Broad public, youth	Episode archive, oral history bank

The movement is explicitly non-commercial. REWILD is envisioned as an open-access, community-driven platform funded through grants, academic partnerships, and crowdfunding. All content will be published under Creative Commons licensing.

03 / PLATFORM PILLARS IN DETAIL

Platform Pillars In Detail

A — Website & Digital Hub

The website is the movement's central nervous system. It must serve multiple audiences simultaneously: the curious layperson, the academic researcher, the activist, and the schoolteacher.

- Home / About: mission, team, manifesto, values
- Ecological Library: articles, essays, curated reading lists on biodiversity, climate, indigenous ecology
- Biodiversity Atlas: interactive map documenting species, ecosystems, traditional land use
- News & Commentary: timely ecological journalism and opinion with evidence base
- Submit / Contribute: portal for community submissions, field observations, creative work
- Events Calendar: seminars, calls for papers, podcast drops
- Resource Hub: links to vetted databases (GBIF, iNaturalist, IPBES, Sacred Groves Project)

B — Call for Papers & Publications

REWILD will publish a biannual interdisciplinary journal and occasional essay collections. The Call for Papers (CfP) process is a key mechanism for building academic legitimacy and attracting contributors from Environmental Studies, Literature, Anthropology, Geography, and the Arts.

- Themes: ecological grief, rewilding narratives, traditional ecological knowledge (TEK), environmental humanities, nature writing, postcolonial ecology
- Formats: research papers (5,000–8,000 words), creative nonfiction, poems, photo essays, field notes
- Review process: open peer review with transparency logs
- Distribution: open-access via platform + DOAJ listing
- Annual CfP cycle with rolling editorial board from partner universities

C — Seminars & Public Events

Regular seminars serve both as educational programming and as community-building events. REWILD seminars will be free, recorded, and made available on the platform archive.

- Monthly public webinars: ecologists, writers, indigenous scholars, artists
- Quarterly workshops: participatory, skills-based (nature journaling, community mapping, oral history recording)
- Annual REWILD Summit: flagship convergence event bringing together all collaborators
- School & university outreach: guest lecture programme and curriculum-aligned workshops
- Partner with existing events: Earth Day, World Environment Day, literary festivals

D — Podcasts & Digital Storytelling

The podcast is REWILD's most intimate and scalable medium. It reaches audiences who do not read journals, translates complex ecology into narrative form, and archives voices — particularly indigenous and community voices — that academic publishing often excludes.

- Series 1 — 'Voices of the Land': interviews with forest communities, farmers, fisherfolk

- Series 2 — 'Reading the Earth': literary ecology — how great writers have understood nature
- Series 3 — 'The Science Understory': accessible conversations with ecologists and conservationists
- Mini-series: biodiversity soundscapes (field recordings + narration)
- Distribution: Spotify, Apple Podcasts, SoundCloud, platform-hosted

Technology Roadmap

Lead: Sanjay Kumar | Engineering & Digital Infrastructure

The technology stack should prioritise open-source tools, low cost, scalability, and accessibility (WCAG 2.1 compliance, multilingual support). Every technical decision must serve the mission: ecological literacy for everyone.

4.1 Core Website Infrastructure

Component	Recommended Tool / Technology	Rationale
CMS / Framework	WordPress (or Astro + Sanity CMS for performance)	Ease of content management; large plugin ecosystem
Hosting	Netlify / Vercel (static) or DigitalOcean (dynamic)	Low cost, high uptime, scalable
Domain & SSL	Namecheap / Cloudflare DNS + Let's Encrypt	Affordable; free HTTPS
Search	Algolia (free tier) or Lunr.js (local)	Fast full-text search across library
Database	PostgreSQL (submissions, user data)	Reliable, open-source relational DB
Email / Newsletter	Mailchimp (free tier) or Sendy (self-hosted)	Community outreach, CFP announcements
Analytics	Plausible (privacy-first) or Umami	GDPR-compliant, no Google dependency

4.2 Biodiversity Atlas & Interactive Mapping

Feature	Tool / API	Purpose
Base map layer	Leaflet.js + OpenStreetMap	Free, open-source interactive maps
Species data overlay	GBIF API / iNaturalist API	Real biodiversity occurrence data
Community contribution	Custom GeoJSON upload form	Allow field submissions from community
Indigenous land mapping	Native Land Digital API	Overlay traditional territory data
Satellite / land cover	Google Earth Engine (free academic)	Deforestation, land-use change layers
Biodiversity hotspot layers	IUCN Red List API	Threatened species spatial data

4.3 Podcast & Media Infrastructure

Component	Tool	Notes
Recording & editing	Audacity / Reaper (free/low-cost)	Local production; remote via Riverside.fm
Podcast hosting	Anchor (Spotify) / Buzzsprout	Free distribution to all major platforms
Video (seminars)	StreamYard / OBS Studio	Professional live-streaming, free tier

Video archiving	YouTube (channel) + platform embed	Maximum discoverability
Transcript generation	Whisper (OpenAI, local/free)	Auto-transcripts for accessibility
Oral history archive	Omeka-S (open-source)	Structured archiving of field recordings

4.4 Emerging Technologies & Digital Storytelling

- Citizen Science App: Build or fork an iNaturalist-style app for community species reporting; integrate with the platform Atlas.
- AR / QR Nature Trails: Deploy QR codes in parks and nature reserves linking to REWILD content about local species and ecosystems.
- Data Visualisation: D3.js dashboards showing biodiversity trends, deforestation data, and conservation outcomes.
- AI-assisted tagging: Use open-source NLP to auto-tag submissions by species, ecosystem, region for searchability.
- Digital Storytelling Platform: Story Maps (ArcGIS StoryMaps or open equivalent) for long-form multimedia ecological narratives.
- Accessibility: Multilingual interface (initially English + Hindi + Tamil); screen reader compliance; low-bandwidth mode.

Humanities & Discourse Roadmap

Lead: Prasanna Kumar | Literature, Ecology & Cultural Programming

The humanities dimension of REWILD distinguishes it from conventional conservation platforms. Environmental humanities — drawing on ecocriticism, postcolonial ecology, indigenous studies, and cultural geography — provides the interpretive frameworks through which ecological facts become stories, and stories become action.

5.1 Editorial & Intellectual Framework

- Develop REWILD's editorial philosophy: a manifesto on ecological humanism and interdisciplinary inquiry.
- Define five annual thematic foci (e.g., Year 1: Forest Worlds; Year 2: Water Ecologies; Year 3: Urban Nature).
- Commission inaugural essays from scholars across Environmental Humanities, Postcolonial Studies, and Indigenous Studies.
- Build an editorial board: target academics from JNU, Hyderabad, EFLU, international programs (University of Sussex, Yale School of Environment).
- Establish a glossary of ecological literacy terms — bridging scientific and humanistic vocabularies.

5.2 Call for Papers: Thematic Framework

CfP Theme	Theoretical Traditions	Example Texts & Thinkers
Rewilding Narratives	Ecocriticism, New Nature Writing	Robert Macfarlane, Robin Wall Kimmerer, Gary Snyder
Ecological Grief & Climate Literature	Climate Grief, Nostalgia (Albrecht), Affect Theory	Richard Powers, Amitav Ghosh (The Nutmeg's Curse)
Indigenous Ecological Knowledge	Decolonial Theory, TEK Studies	Vine Deloria Jr., Potawatomi Nation traditions, Vandana Shiva
Postcolonial Ecologies	Postcolonial Studies, Environmental Justice	Rob Nixon (Slow Violence), Ramachandra Guha
Nature in South Asian Literature	Regional ecocriticism, vernacular ecology	Rajiv Kumar, Mahasweta Devi, Kamala Das
Art, Music & Ecological Feeling	Aesthetic theory, Rasa, Soundscape Studies	Murray Schafer, Anna Tsing

5.3 Seminar Programming

- Inaugural Webinar Series: 'What Does It Mean to Read Ecologically?' — six-part lecture series covering ecocriticism from early Romantics (Wordsworth, Clare) to contemporary cli-fi.
- Workshop: 'Writing the Land' — creative writing workshop for nature essays, environmental memoir, and ecological poetry.
- Annual REWILD Lecture: keynote from a major figure in environmental humanities or ecology (target year 1: invite a Robin Wall Kimmerer-aligned scholar).
- Roundtable Series: 'Ecology and the Classroom' — pedagogy-focused discussions for teachers incorporating ecological literacy.
- Collaborate with literary festivals (Jaipur Literature Festival, Kerala Literature Festival) for panel programming.

5.4 Podcast Content Architecture

Series	Format	Sample Episode Ideas
Voices of the Land	30–45 min interviews	A Himalayan shepherd on seasonal migration routes; a Gond artist on forest cosmology
Reading the Earth	20–30 min literary ecology	Wordsworth's spots of nature; Tagore's Santiniketan as ecological philosophy; An ancient forest in the Western Ghats
The Science Understory	35–45 min scientist interviews	Bio-diversity hotspots in the Western Ghats; rewilding projects in Rajasthan; soundscapes of a rainforest
Seedlings (Youth Edition)	10–15 min youth-focused	Why do bees matter? The story of seeds; rivers that remember

06 / RESPONSIBILITY MATRIX

Responsibility Matrix: Who Does What

SANJAY KUMAR — Technology Lead	PRASANNA KUMAR — Humanities Lead
Website design, development & maintenance	Editorial strategy, content vision, manifesto drafting
Biodiversity atlas / interactive mapping tool	Call for Papers design, thematic frameworks, reviewing submissions
Podcast production infrastructure (hosting, editing suite)	Podcast content — story selection, interview questions, scripting, narration
Social media automation & scheduling tools	Social media content writing — captions, essays, literary ecology posts
Analytics, SEO and digital performance monitoring	Academic outreach — university partnerships, editorial board building
Online submission portal (CfP, community contributions)	Seminar programming — speaker curation, moderation, curriculum design
Citizen science / mobile app development	Indigenous knowledge documentation — community liaison, ethical protocols
Data visualisation dashboards (biodiversity, climate)	Writing: feature essays, book reviews, ecological criticism
Live-streaming & recording setup for seminars	Grant writing and partnership proposals (co-authored with Sanjay)
Cybersecurity, backups, GDPR compliance	Spoken word, creative writing programming and literary events
API integrations (GBIF, iNaturalist, IUCN)	Translation & multilingual content strategy (Hindi, Tamil, vernacular)

07 / THREE-PHASE IMPLEMENTATION TIMELINE

Three-Phase Implementation Timeline

PHASE 1 — FOUNDATION | Months 1–4

Establish the foundational infrastructure, brand identity, and initial content base before any public launch.

Milestone	Sanjay (Tech)	Prasanna (Humanities)	Month
Brand identity & logo	Domain, hosting, basic site skeleton	Movement manifesto & naming rationale	1
Core website live (beta)	WordPress/CMS setup, navigation	About page, mission statement, 5 seed articles	2
Social media launch	Accounts setup, scheduling tools	Content calendar, 30 launch posts written	2
Podcast infrastructure	Recording setup, hosting account	Series 1 concept doc, first 3 episode scripts	3
First two podcast episodes	Upload, distribution to all platforms	Record, narrate, edit with Sanjay	3–4
CfP announcement	Submission portal live	CfP text drafted, theme announced	4

PHASE 2 — ACTIVATION | Months 5–10

Public launch, first major events, academic engagement, and growth of the community.

Milestone	Sanjay (Tech)	Prasanna (Humanities)	Month
Public website launch	Full site live, analytics active	Launch essay published; press release	5
Biodiversity Atlas beta	Leaflet map + GBIF data integrated	Write 10 ecological field notes for map pins	6
Inaugural seminar	Stream setup, recording, archive page	Speaker secured, moderation, promotion	6
First CfP closes + review	Submission data organised	Coordinate peer review, editorial decisions	7–8
Monthly podcast cadence	Consistent upload schedule	4 episodes/month across series	5–10
University partnerships	Platform accounts for partner institutions	MOU discussions with 2–3 universities	8
First publication issue	Digital journal formatted for web	Edited, intro essay, designed issue	9–10

PHASE 3 — EXPANSION | Months 11–24

Scale the platform, deepen community roots, seek institutional funding, and consolidate REWILD as a reference destination.

Milestone	Sanjay (Tech)	Prasanna (Humanities)	Timeline
Citizen science app launch	Mobile app (React Native / Flutter)	App content, species ID guides	Month 12
Annual REWILD Summit	Virtual + hybrid event tech	Programme design, keynote curation	Month 14

Second journal issue	Updated site design, new features	Themed issue with invited essays	Month 16
Oral history archive live	Omeka-S deployment	Field recording trips, community liaison	Month 18
Multilingual content	i18n site infrastructure	Hindi and Tamil content commissioning	Month 20
Grant applications	Technical documentation for funders	Narrative writing: Ford, Ashoka, CSF India	Ongoing
Podcast: 50 episodes	Analytics report, monetisation review	Series 3 and 4 launched	Month 24

Content Strategy & Editorial Calendar

Annual Thematic Calendar

Month	Global Occasion	REWILD Theme	Output
January	New Year / Season	Forests & Rewilding Narratives	Long essay + podcast episode
February	World Wetlands Day (Feb 2)	Wetlands & Water Ecologies	Feature article + mapping layer
March	World Wildlife Day (Mar 3)	Endangered Species & Biodiversity	Species spotlight series x4
April	Earth Day (Apr 22)	Climate & Ecological Grief	Seminar + CfP launch
May	International Biodiversity Day (May 22)	Indigenous Ecological Knowledge	Oral history podcast episode
June	World Environment Day (Jun 5)	Sustainable Living	Workshop + guide publication
July–Aug	Monsoon / Field Season	Field Notes & Citizen Science	Community submission drive
September	World Rivers Day (Sep)	River Ecologies & Water Justice	Illustrated essay + map update
October	World Habitat Day	Urban Nature & Green Infrastructure	Roundtable seminar
November	COP / Climate Season	Climate Justice & Policy Ecology	Policy brief + podcast series
December	Year in Review	Annual REWILD Report	Journal issue + year in ecology recap

Social Media Strategy

Platform	Content Type	Frequency	Prasanna's Role	Sanjay's Role
Instagram	Visual ecology, quotes, nature photography, infographics	Daily	Captions, literary ecology quotes	Scheduling, design templates, analytics
Twitter/X	Commentary, links, research threads	2-3x daily	Academic threads, essay excerpts	Automation, link tracking
YouTube	Seminar recordings, podcast video versions, nature documentaries	Weekly	Scripts, intro/outro, descriptions	Upload, SEO, channel management
LinkedIn	Academic announcements, CfP, partnerships	3x weekly	Professional updates, editorial updates	Analytics setup, posting schedule
Substack	Long-form ecology essays, editorials	Bi-weekly	All writing	Technical setup, subscriber management

Reference Ecosystem: Inspirations & Resources

Movements & Platforms to Study

Name	Type	What REWILD Can Learn
Dark Mountain Project (UK)	Literary-ecological manifesto	Univocal narrative, long-form ecological essays, annual anthology model
iNaturalist	Citizen science platform	Community observation model, species documentation, open API — Sanjay Kumar
The Emergence Magazine	Ecology & humanities journal	Premium long-form nature writing, art-science integration, visual design strategy
Mongabay India	Environmental journalism	Evidence-based reporting, regional language editions, community sourcing
The Robin Wall Kimmerer Network	Indigenous science & humanities	TikTok integration, storytelling as scientific methodology, ethical engagement
ATREE (Bengaluru)	Indian conservation research	Academic partnership model, interdisciplinary ecology with local communities
Ramachandra Guha's Body of Work	Postcolonial environmental history	Framework for Indian ecological thought — Chipko, Narmada, forest rights
Rewilding Britain / Rewilding Europe	Conservation movement	Rewilding science, policy advocacy, public communication model
Soundscape Ecology Network	Acoustic biology research	Podcast + field recording methodology; bioacoustic documentation
The Keralam Project	Regional ecological documentation	Vernacular ecological knowledge archiving in Indian context

Key Books for REWILD's Intellectual Framework

- Robin Wall Kimmerer — Braiding Sweetgrass: Indigenous Wisdom, Scientific Knowledge and the Teaching of Plants
- Amitav Ghosh — The Nutmeg's Curse: Parables for a Planet in Crisis
- Rob Nixon — Slow Violence and the Environmentalism of the Poor
- Ramachandra Guha & Juan Martinez-Alier — Varieties of Environmentalism
- Anna Tsing — The Mushroom at the End of the World: On the Possibility of Life in Capitalist Ruins
- Richard Powers — The Overstory (fiction as ecological pedagogy)
- Vandana Shiva — Staying Alive: Women, Ecology and Development
- Robert Macfarlane — Underland & The Wild Places (New Nature Writing)
- Tim Ingold — The Perception of the Environment: Essays on Livelihood, Dwelling and Skill
- Dipesh Chakrabarty — The Climate of History in a Planetary Age
- Gary Snyder — Turtle Island (ecological poetry)
- Ursula K. Le Guin — The Word for World is Forest (speculative ecology)

Podcasts to Reference & Learn From

- On Being (Krista Tippett) — spirituality, ecology, science and meaning
- Radiolab — narrative science journalism; gold standard for accessible complexity

- Emergence Magazine Podcast — ecology, culture, language and belonging
- The Climate Question (BBC World Service) — policy and personal ecology
- Ologies (Alie Ward) — enthusiastic, accessible wildlife and ecology science
- For The Wild — philosophical ecology and rewilding conversations
- Costing the Earth (BBC Radio 4) — British environmental journalism benchmark
- Gulabi Gang Podcast — Indian feminist ecology and community action

Databases & Open-Access Resources

- GBIF (Global Biodiversity Information Facility) — gbif.org — species occurrence data, open API
- iNaturalist — inaturalist.org — citizen science species observation platform
- IPBES — ipbes.net — Intergovernmental Science-Policy Platform on Biodiversity and Ecosystem Services
- IUCN Red List — iucnredlist.org — threatened species data and assessments
- Sacred Groves Project (India) — documentation of traditional forest conservation practices
- ENVIS (Environmental Information System, MoEF India) — Indian biodiversity and policy data
- Biodiversity Heritage Library — biodiversitylibrary.org — historic natural history literature, open access
- Open Library of Humanities — olh.openlibhums.org — peer-reviewed humanities journals, free access
- Shodhganga (INFLIBNET) — shodhganga.inflibnet.ac.in — Indian doctoral theses, open access
- JSTOR Global Plants / Global Access — free access for developing country researchers

10 / NEXT STEPS & IMMEDIATE MILESTONES

Next Steps & Immediate Milestones

Immediate Actions (Next 30 Days)

#	Action	Owner	Done When
1	Finalise movement name, logo, and brand colours	Both	Logo file + brand guide
2	Register domain (rewild.in / rewild.org / rewildmovement.org)	Sanjay	Domain active
3	Set up hosting account and install CMS	Sanjay	Staging site accessible
4	Draft and publish the REWILD Manifesto (1,500 words)	Prasanna	Posted on About page
5	Create social media accounts on Instagram, Twitter, YouTube, and LinkedIn	Sanjay	Accounts live with bio
6	Write 5 seed articles for the Ecological Library (ecology + life + culture)	Prasanna	5 articles ready to publish
7	Record first podcast episode (Series 1 — Voices of the Land)	Both	Episode audio file
8	Set up podcast hosting on Anchor / Buzzsprout	Sanjay	Feed URL generated
9	Draft first CfP announcement	Prasanna	CfP text ready
10	Identify 3 potential editorial board members from academia	Prasanna	3 confirmed contacts

Funding Strategy

- Tier 1 — Crowdfunding (Months 1–3): Launch a Kickstarter / Milaap campaign explaining the mission. Target: INR 2–3 lakhs for first-year operating costs.
- Tier 2 — Academic Micro-Grants (Months 4–8): Apply to University of Delhi, EFLU, and JNU small grant schemes for educational platform development.
- Tier 3 — Environmental Foundation Grants (Months 6–12): Apply to India Climate Collaborative, Ashoka Trust for Ecology & Environment (ATREE), Bombay Natural History Society.
- Tier 4 — International Grants (Year 2): Ford Foundation, British Council's Cultural Protection Fund, Goethe-Institut's ecology-culture programmes.
- Long-term: Open-access journal with Article Processing Charges (APC) waived for early contributors; institutional subscriptions for organisations.

A Closing Note

REWILD begins not with a platform but with a commitment: to pay attention. Before the first article is published or the first line of code is written, both of you must spend time in a forest, beside a river, in a field — and listen. Every great ecological movement has begun with that act of witnessing. The rest is infrastructure.

This document is a living plan. Revise it every six months. Let the movement teach you what it needs to become.